

Indus Valley Civilization

The Indus Valley Civilization is also known as the Harappa Civilization. *Archaeologists use the term '**culture**' for a group of objects, distinctive in style, that are usually found together within a specific geographical area and at a period of time. *In the case of Harappan culture, these distinctive objects include **seals, beads, weights, stone blades** and even **baked bricks**.

*The Harappan seal is possibly the most distinctive artefact of the Harappan or Indus Valley civilization. **John Marshall**, Director-General of the ASI, announced the discovery of a new civilization in the Indus Valley to the world in 1921.

*Harappa is located in the **Montgomery district** (currently it is Sahiwal district) of Punjab province, Pakistan. ***Mohenjodaro** is located on the right bank of the Indus River in **Larkana District** of Sindh Province Pakistan. *According to Stuart Piggott, the two cities, Harappa and Mohenjodaro were “**Twin capitals of an Extensive Kingdom**”. *Harappa is located at the left bank of Ravi River.

*The carbon-14 (C¹⁴) dating process indicates the Harappan period to be from 2300 BC to 1700 BC which is highly accepted. During the period 2300 BC to 1900 B.C., the growth of this civilization was at its peak. **Mesopotamia** and **Egyptian civilization** are contemporary to the Indus civilization. The timeline of the Indus Valley civilization by various researchers –

Researcher	Timeline
John Marshall	3250 B.C. -2750 B.C.
Ernest Mackay	2800 B.C. – 2500 B.C.
Madho Sarup Vats	3500 B.C. – 2000 B.C.
C.J. Gadd	2350 B.C. – 1700 B.C.
Mortimer Wheeler	2500 B.C. – 1500 B.C.
Walter A. Fairservis	2000 B.C. – 1500 B.C.

*The Harappan culture covered parts of Afghanistan, Punjab, Sindh, Baluchistan in Pakistan and in India Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana, the fringes of western Uttar Pradesh, J & K, Western Maharashtra. It extended from Manda (Jammu and Kashmir) in the north to the Daimabad (Maharashtra) in the South, and from the Sutkagen Dor of Baluchistan in the West to Alamgirpur Meerut (Uttar Pradesh) in the east. The area formed a triangle and accounted for about 13 lakh square kilometers which is larger than Pakistan and certainly bigger than ancient Egypt and Mesopotamia.

*As the evidence stands, the population of Mohenjodaro was a mixture of at least four races –

1. Proto-Australoids (Caucasian)
2. Mediterraneans
3. Alpines

4. Mongoloids

*Founders of Indus Valley civilization based on the assessments of various archaeologists -

S.N.	Archaeologists	Founder
1.	Dr. Laxman Swaroop	Arya
2.	V. Gordon Childe and Wheeler	Sumerians
3.	Rakhal Das Banerji	Dravidians (Dravid)

*The cities excavated in Indus Valley area can be categorized in the following groups.

1. Central city
2. Coastal city and dockyards
3. Other cities and towns

*The four major cities of Indus Valley civilization- Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Banawali and Dholavira were the large towns.

*The vast mounds were first reported by **Charles Masson** in **1826**. *January 1921, Mr. Dayaram Sahni surveyed the Harappa site in the Montgomery district (currently in Sahiwal) of Punjab (Pakistan) on the left bank of Ravi river and excavation process started with continuity. During the years **1926-27 to 1933-34**, **Mr. Madho Sarup Vats** and in **1946** Mr. Mortimer wheeler had started the excavation process. *Harappa had two mounds, the eastern side mound was known as city mound and the western one was called Citadel mound. The remnants of **Granary** were available in the form of 12 rooms, which were arranged in the form of two rows each, having six rooms each. *The first artefact uncovered in Harappa was a unique stone seal carved with a **unicorn** and an inscription. Similar seals with different animal symbols and writings have been found throughout the region. Although the writing has not yet been deciphered, evidence found during the early archaeological excavations is the major source to know about the Harappan culture. *The figures of **elephant, rhinoceros, tiger, deer, sheep** etc. are depicted on the seals and terracotta art of Harappan culture. But the **cow** was not depicted on the seals and terracotta art of the Harappan cultures.

*Mohenjodaro is a Sindhi language word whose literal translation means “**Mound of the dead**”. Mohenjodaro is located on the right bank of the Indus River in Larkana district, Sindh, Pakistan. Mohenjodaro was discovered by **Rakhal Das Banerjee** in 1922. *The most important public place of Mohenjodaro seems to be the **Great Bath**. This great bath seems to have been used for ritual bathing. *In Mohenjodaro, a large building, in the form of ruins, has been obtained. This is in the northeast direction of the great bath, with the dimensions 70.1 × 23.77 meters. This building, perhaps meant for the residence of a very high official, possibly the high priest himself or a college of priests. *The main quality of Mohenjodaro was their **roads**. The main road had a width of 9.15 meters, which

is known as Rajpath. The straight roads intersect each other at the right angle and the parted roads form square and quadrangle shapes. *The artefacts found from Mohenjodaro are **mother goddess idol, dancing girl statue, a seated male soapstone (Priest-King), Pashupati (Shiva) seal and skeleton** in the wells, teeth of horse, evidence of cotton cloth etc.

*The **Chanhudaro** situated about 130 km south of Mohenjodaro was discovered by **N.G. Majumdar** in **1931** and excavated on a large scale by **E.J.H. Mackay** in **1935-36**. *Remnants of **Jhukkar** and **Jhangar culture** were found at this site. This place may have been an industrial hub where shell making, bangle making and bead making took place. Ornamented elephant, toys, the vestige of a dog that followed a cat, lipsticks etc have been found at this site.

*Lothal is situated on the Bhogava River in **Ahmedabad** district of Gujarat. It was discovered by **S.R. Rao**. Along the eastern side of the town was a brick-basin, which has been identified as a **dockyard** by its excavator. Lothal city on the basis of planning and material goods seems to be micro Harappa or micro Mohenjodaro city. The evidence of **Rice husk, metal workers, shell ornament makers, bead makers, shop, fire altars, a terracotta figurine of a horse, a terracotta model of a ship, a Persian seal, painted jar** etc has been found here.

***Kalibangan** is located in **Hanumangarh** district of Rajasthan. Excavation was started by **B.B. Lal & B.K. Thapar** in 1960-61. ***Ploughed field surface** has been found at this site. The pieces of evidence of **Mesopotamian seals, wheels of a toy cart, and fire altars** are found here.

***Dholavira**, which is the second largest site of Harappan Civilization in India (after Rakhigarhi) is located in Rann of Kachchh (Gujarat). **R.S. Bisht and his colleagues excavated it in 1990-91**. *Dholavira is one of the most prominent archaeological sites of Harappa, which gives us important information about the great bath and reservoir. *The town was built in a rectangular shape. It was divided into **three parts** - Citadel, middle town and lower town. People of Dholavira were familiar with the **advanced water management system**. From the earliest evidence, people used to store water in this reservoir by building dams.

***Surkotada** is located in Kachchh district of Gujarat. The evidence of horse bones and **pot burials** has been found here.

***Daimabad** is situated on the left bank of the Pravara River in **Ahmednagar** (now Ahilyanagar) district of Maharashtra. This site was discovered by B.P. Bopardikar in 1958. Daimabad is famous for the recovery of many bronze goods, some of which were influenced by Harappan culture. ***Rakhigarhi** is situated in the **Hisar** district of Haryana. This site is located in the Ghaggar-Hakra River plain. This site is the **largest site of Indus Valley civilization in India**. ***Ropar** (Punjab) is located on the left bank of the river Satluj. The current name of this city is Rupnagar. This city was discovered by B.B. Lal in 1950. This site was excavated by Yagyadatt Sharma in 1953-55. ***Rangpur** is located in the Saurashtra region of western India, on the coast of the Arabian Sea in Gujarat state. On the basis of large vegetative remains, it can be said

that these people used to cultivate Rice, Bajra and Sorghum.

***Dadheri** (Kotla Dadheri) was a pre-historic excavation site of Govindgarh, district Fatehgarh Sahib (Punjab). Dadheri is known for its **painted grey ware culture**, which is supposed to be associated with the arrival of the Aryans.

Major sites of Indus Valley Civilization and related rivers –

Sites	Rivers
Harappa	Ravi
Mohenjodaro	Indus
Kalibangan	Ghaggar
Lothal	Bhogwa
Ropar	Sutlej
Manda	Chenab
Daimabad	Pravara
Alamgirpur	Hindon
Sutkagendor	Dasht
Bhagwanpura	Sarasvati

***Alamgirpur** is located in Meerut district of Uttar Pradesh. It is situated along the Hindon River. A small terracotta bead-like structure coated with gold and evidence of cloth was found at this site. Utensils with triangle, peacock and squirrel impressions were found here.

***Hulas** is located in Saharanpur district of Uttar Pradesh. Hand made and wheel made pottery with geometric or naturalistic designs painted in black, chert blades, bone points etc. have been found here. ***Banawali** is located in the Fatehabad district of Haryana. Clay figures of the mother goddess and **toy plough** have been found here.

***Bhagwanpura** is located in Kurukshetra district, Haryana. It is located on the Southern bank of river Saraswati. The site was excavated by J.P. Joshi. ***Manda** is situated on the bank of river Chenab in Jammu and Kashmir. It was excavated by J.P. Joshi and Madhubala in 1982. It is considered a site used to procure wood from Himalayan regions and send them downstream to other towns of the Indus Valley civilization.

***Sinauli** is an archaeological site located in Baraut Tehsil, Baghpat district, Uttar Pradesh, where 125 graves belonging to the Indus Valley Civilization were found. These graves are oriented in a **North-South direction** and most are identified as primary human burials. Some of the burials are found with animal bones, gold, copper and bangles.

*Harappans were known to **silver**. The evidence of its proper use has been found from Mohenjodaro and Harappa. These people used to get silver from mines of **Zawar** and **Ajmer** in Rajasthan. Other sources of silver for Harappa and Mohenjodaro were Afghanistan and Iran.

*The Harappan pottery is bright or dark red and uniformly sturdy and well baked. It consists of wheel-made wares, both plain and painted. The plain wares are usually of red clay with or

without a fine red slip. The painted pottery was of red and black colours. Several methods were used by people for the decoration of pottery. Polychrome pottery was rare and mainly comprised small vases decorated with geometric patterns, mostly in red, black and green and less frequently in white and yellow. The colour- scheme adopted for painting was light black, chocolate or light red over buff or greenish- buff background. *The Indus Valley Civilization was a Bronze age Civilization. People of this age were not familiar with **iron**. *The drainage system was advanced and covered with slabs. *The trade and commerce were in an advanced stage. The pieces of evidence of both internal and external trade have been found. *Many pieces of evidence of worshipping of Mother Goddess from Indus Valley have been found.

*Marshall identified the figure which he found during excavation as an early form of the Hindu **God Shiva (or Rudra)** or **Pashupati** (lord of animals) from the excavation of Harappa. The Pashupati seal in which the **three faced male God** is shown sitting in a yogic posture, surrounded by a **Rhino** and a **Buffalo** on right side and an **Elephant** and a **Tiger** on the left side, make the historian conclude that the people of those days worshipped Lord Shiva and cylindrical stones show that the people worshipped Lingam, the symbol of Lord Shiva. ***Cotton** was first cultivated in India for clothing. The evidence of the earliest cotton cultivation was found in excavations in India. From India, it reached to Greece where it was called "**Sindon**". The cotton cultivation in India started in 3000 BC while it was cultivated in Egypt in 2500 BC. *Indus Valley Civilization is considered to be a secular civilization with no trace of theocratic or organized religion. *No temple or place of worship has been found after excavation from Indus Valley Civilization till date. The only religious source from this civilization is statues made of mud and stone and seals which were found here. By this, it is known that female deities, Shiva or Pashupati and animals like snakes, elephants were worshipped. Worship of plants and trees, or inanimate stone or other objects in the form of '**Linga**' or '**Yoni**' symbols was famous during that period.

Major metals and their production site –

Metals	Production sites
Copper	Khetri(Rajasthan), Balochistan and Oman
Lazurite	Badakhshan (Afghanistan)
Tin	Iran, Afghanistan
Silver	Jawar and Ajmer mines of Rajasthan, Afghanistan and Iran
Lead	Afghanistan, Iran and Rajasthan (India)
Shilajit	Himalaya
Garnet stone (Gomed)	Gujarat
Gold	South India (Karnataka)

*Ancient Egyptian Civilization flourished along the banks of the river Nile for almost 3,000 years. **Nile river** is known as '**lifeline of Egypt**.' The Nile is a major north-flowing river in northeastern Africa, generally regarded as the longest river in the world. Indus Valley Civilization (India) and Mesopotamian civilisation of Iraq are the contemporary civilizations. The correct sequence of the civilizations from North to South is: **Aztec - Maya- Muisca - Inca**. The expansion of Aztec civilization was on the Northern Part of Mesoamerica. Mesoamerica included the Region from central Mexico, Belize, Guatemala, El Salvador, Honduras, Nicaragua and Northern Costa Rica. Mayan civilization was spread over the southern part of Mesoamerica. Moiscu civilization was distributed in the eastern part of Colombia (South America continent), whereas Inca civilization is spread in the western part of south America from the north of Quito and to Santiago in the south. *People of Sumerian Civilization were the first to develop the **art of writing** in a proper system. Their original script was very simple and primitive. *The Cuneiform script of Sumeria is generally known as one of the earliest systems of writing.

Researchers and their opinion on the disappearance of Indus Valley Civilization –

Reason of devastation	Researchers
Flood	Marshall, Mackay, S.R. Rao
Attack of Aryan's	Gordon Childe, Mortimer Wheeler and Stuart Piggott
Climate change	Aurel Stein, Amalananda Ghosh
Geological change	M.R. Sahni, H.T. Lambrick, G.F. Dales
Epidemic	K.U.R. Kennedy

1. **Human Society is unique because it depends mainly on–**
 (a) Culture (b) Economy
 (c) Religion (d) Science
U.P.P.C.S.(Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

Human Society mainly depends on the economy. As the economy changes, human society changes accordingly.

2. **Which of the following is related to Harappa civilization?**
 (a) Sumerian civilization
 (b) Indus Valley Civilization
 (c) Vedic civilization
 (d) Mesopotamian civilization

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

Harappa is an archaeological site related to Indus Valley Civilization. Since the first archaeological evidence of this civilization was obtained from Harappa. Indus Valley Civilization is also known as Harappa Civilization. Along with ancient Egypt and Mesopotamia, it was one of the three ancient civilizations of the world.

3. Indus Civilization existed in–

- (a) Prehistoric age (b) Proto-historic age
- (c) Historic age (d) Post-Historic age

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996
39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Historical period is determined with respect to the available written literature. The period before which knowledge of the art of writing was not available is called early historical age. Indus Civilization is a Proto historical civilization although the writing was known during this period, but it is still to be deciphered.

4. Indus Valley civilization was Non-Aryan because -

- (a) It was an Urban Civilization
- (b) It has its own script
- (c) It has an agricultural economy
- (d) It extended up to the Narmada valley

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (a)

Indus Valley Civilization was the earliest known urban civilization of Indian subcontinent whereas Aryan Civilization was a rural civilization.

5. The important reason to keep Indus-Valley civilization before Aryan civilization is –

- (a) Script (b) Town Planning
- (c) Copper (d) Potteries

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

The knowledge of script and town planning of Indus Valley Civilization was more developed than that of Pre-Aryans. Different archaeological pieces of evidence of pottery have been found in the early settlements of Mehrgarh from the Indus Valley Civilization. Pottery found during excavations proves that Indus Valley Civilization existed before Aryan Civilization. The red potteries painted with black figures were the speciality of Harappan Civilization, whereas the grey painted potteries were used by Aryans.

6. The Indus Valley culture was different from the Vedic Civilization because

- (a) It had the amenities of developed city life
- (b) It has a pictographic script
- (c) It lacked knowledge of iron and defensive arrow
- (d) All of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (d)

The culture of the Indus Valley Civilization was different from the Vedic culture in many ways. The Indus Valley Civilization was urban while the Vedic culture was rural. The script of Indus Valley Civilization was of depictive expressions. The people of Indus Valley Civilization did not know the use of iron, whereas the people of Vedic Civilization used iron weapons extensively.

7. The source of knowledge about Harappan culture is:

- (a) Rock edicts
- (b) Writing in terracotta seals
- (c) Archaeological excavations
- (d) All of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The first artefact uncovered in Harappa was a unique stone seal carved with a unicorn and an inscription. Similar seals with different animal symbols and writings have been found throughout the region. Although the writing has not yet been deciphered, evidence found during the early archaeological excavations is the major source to know about the Harappan culture.

8. Which of the following throws light on Harappan culture?

- (a) Inscription
- (b) Archaeological excavations
- (c) Handwriting seals on the utensils
- (d) Religious books.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

9. The main source of knowledge about the inhabitants of Indus Valley civilizations is the discovery of :

- (a) Seals
- (b) Utensils, Jewellery, weapons, tools
- (c) Temple
- (d) Scripts

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The site of Indus Valley Civilization was excavated (started) in year 1921 and objects such as tools, weapons and ornaments of archaeological or historical interest were found there but the main source to know about this civilization is seals. There were more than 3000 seals found.

10. Which of the following matches is not correct regarding the origin of Harappan civilization?

- (a) M. Rafique Mughal - Harappan civilization was inspired by Mesopotamian civilization
- (b) E.J.H. Mackay - Migration of people from Sumer
- (c) Mortimer Wheeler - Migration of the idea of civilization from Western Asia
- (d) Amalandanda Ghosh - Pre-Harappan culture matured to make Harappan civilization

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2013

Ans. (a)

About the origin of the Harappan civilization, many scholars have presented different views. E.J.H. Mackay has considered that the origin of the Harappan civilization was due to the migration of people from Sumer (Mesopotamia), while historians D.H. Gordon and Mortimer Wheeler considered that the Harappan civilization was the result of migration of the idea of civilization from Western Asia. In this context, Amalananda Ghosh considered that pre-Harappan culture matured into Harappan civilization. M.F. Rafique Mughal considered that the development of Harappan civilization occurred in the region of Ravi river at Harappa. He refutes the old belief that Harappan civilization was inspired by Mesopotamian civilization.

11. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I	List-II
A. Harappa	1. N.G. Majumdar (1936-37)
B. Hastinapur	2. John Marshall (1913-34)
C. Takshashila	3. Daya Ram Sahni (1923-24 & 1924-25)
D. Kaushambi	4. B.B. Lal (1950-52)

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	2	1	3
(b)	1	3	4	2
(c)	3	4	2	1
(d)	4	1	3	2

U.P.R.O/A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

List-I	List-II
Harappa	Daya Ram Sahni (1923-24 & 1924-25)
Hastinapur	B.B. Lal (1950-52)
Takshashila	John Marshall (1913-34)
Kaushambi	N.G. Majumdar (1936-37)

12. The earliest evidence of silver in India is found in the-

- Harappan culture
- Chalcolithic cultures of western India
- Vedic texts
- Silver Punch- marked coins

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Harappans were known to silver. The evidence of its proper use has been found from Mohenjodaro and Harappa. These people used to get silver from mines of Zawar and Ajmer in Rajasthan.

13. Which colour was commonly used in the Harappan Pottery?

- Red
- Blue-grey
- Yellow
- Blue

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

The Harappan pottery is bright or dark red and uniformly sturdy and well baked. It consists of wheel-made wares, both plain and painted. The plain ware is usually of red clay with or without a fine red slip. The painted pottery was of red and black colours. Several methods were used by people for the decoration of pottery. Polychrome pottery was rare and mainly comprised small vases decorated with geometric patterns, mostly in red, black and green and less frequently in white and yellow. The colour- scheme adopted for painting was light black, chocolate or light red over buff or greenish buff background.

14. The beginning of idol worship is to be considered in –

- Pre-Aryan
- later Vedic period
- Mauryan Period
- Kushan Period

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The pre-Aryan period is considered as the beginning of idol worship. Idol worship was prevalent in Indus Civilization and it is evident from the coins discovered from Mohenjodaro having the seal of God. They probably worshipped Mother Goddess in addition to male and female deities.

15. Which one of the following animals was not represented on the seals and terracotta art of the Harappan culture?

- Cow
- Elephant
- Rhinoceros
- Tiger

I.A.S. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (a)

The figures of Elephant, Rhinoceros, Tiger, Deer, Sheep etc. are depicted on the seals and terracotta art of Harappan culture. But the Cow was not depicted on the seals and terracotta art of the Harappan cultures.

16. Which one of the following is not a Harappan site?

- Chanhudaro
- Kotdiji
- Sohgaura
- Desalpur

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Sohgaura is a village located on the bank of Rapti river in Gorakhpur district of Uttar Pradesh. A copper plate inscription of Mauryan period has been found here which gives us information about the storehouses present here. Chanhudaro, Kot Diji and Desalpur are Harappan sites. Chanhudaro and Kot Diji are present in the current Sindh province of Pakistan whereas Desalpur is located in the Kachchh region of Gujarat.

17. Match List-I (Ancient site) with List-II (Archaeological finding) and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists :

List-I (Ancient site)	List-II (Archaeological finding)
A. Lothal	1. Ploughed field
B. Kalibangan	2. Dockyard
C. Dholavira	3. Terracotta replica of a Plough
D. Banawali	4. An inscription comprising ten large-sized signs of the Harappan script

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	1	4	3
(c)	1	2	4	3
(d)	2	1	3	4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

The archaeological remains of the Harappan port-town of Lothal are located along the Bhogava River, a tributary of Sabarmati, in the Gulf of Cambay. Kalibangan town is located on the bank of Ghaggar River (Saraswati River) in Hanumangarh district, Rajasthan. Kalibangan has given the evidence of the earliest ploughed agricultural field ever revealed through excavation. An inscription comprising ten large-sized signs of the Harappan script was found in the Dholavira of Harappan script. Banawali is located in the Fatehabad district of Haryana from where a terracotta replica of a plough was found.

18. A ploughed field was discovered at –
 (a) Mohenjodaro (b) Kalibangan
 (c) Harappa (d) Lothal

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

19. In which of the following Harappan cities, furrows of ploughed fields have been found?
 (a) Kalibangan
 (b) Dholavira
 (c) Mohenjo-daro
 (d) Lothal
 (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B. P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

See the above explanation

20. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I	List-II
A. Harappa	1. Cemetery R-37
B. Lothal	2. Dockyard

- C. Kalibangan 3. Dancing Girl Statue
 D. Mohenjo-Daro 4. Furrowed land
 Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	1	4	3
(c)	3	4	1	2
(d)	1	2	4	3

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (d)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

List-I	List-II
Harappa	Cemetery R-37
Lothal	Dockyard
Kalibangan	Furrowed land
Mohenjo-Daro	Dancing Girl Statue

21. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below the lists :

List-I	List-II
A. Harappa	1. Godavari
B. Hastinapur	2. Ravi
C. Nagarjuna Konda	3. Ganga
D. Paithan	4. Krishna

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	4	3	2	1
(d)	3	4	1	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

Harappa	Ravi river
Hastinapur	Ganga river
Nagarjuna Konda	Krishna river
Paithan	Godavari river

22. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below :

List – I (Harappan Settlement)	List – II (River on which located)
A. Harappa	1. Bhogava
B. Kalibangan	2. Ghaggar
C. Lothal	3. Ravi
D. Ropar	4. Sutlej

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	1	4
(b)	3	4	1	2
(c)	4	2	3	1
(d)	1	3	2	4

Ans. (a)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

Village		River
Harappa	-	Ravi
Kalibangan	-	Ghaggar
Lothal	-	Bhogava
Ropar	-	Sutlej

Hence, option (a) is correct.

23. Harappa was situated on the bank of river

- (a) Beas (b) Sutlej
(c) Ravi (d) Ghaggar

[Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains)-2016]

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

24. The Great Bath was found from the Indus Valley civilization at -

- (a) Mohenjodaro (b) Harappa
(c) Lothal (d) Kalibangan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

The Great Bath is one of the well-known structures among the ruins of the ancient Indus Valley Civilization at Mohenjodaro in Sindh, Pakistan.

25. The 'Great Bath' was found at the archaeological site of -

- (a) Ropar (b) Harappa
(c) Mohenjodaro (d) Kalibangan

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

26. From which archaeological site of Indus Valley Civilization, the figures or models of boat are found?

- (a) Harappa and Kot Diji
(b) Kalibangan and Ropar
(c) Dhaulabira and Bhagatray
(d) Mohenjodaro and Lothal

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

Clay model boats have been found from Lothal's excavation. From Mohenjodaro seals having model of boat were discovered during excavation.

27. Which of the following statements about the Indus civilization is not true?

- (a) Accurate drainage system in cities
(b) Trade and commerce were in an advanced stage.
(c) Worshipping of Mother Goddess
(d) People knew about iron

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

The Indus Valley Civilization was a Bronze Age Civilization. People of this Age were not familiar with iron. The drainage system was advanced and covered with slabs. The trade and commerce were in an advanced stage. The pieces of evidence of both internal and external trade have been found. Many pieces of evidence of worshipping of Mother Goddess from Indus Valley Civilization have been found.

28. Based on findings of excavation of Harappan Civilization, what are not true?

(i) For all kinds of constructions, same size of bricks were used.

(ii) Mostly all the houses were single storey.

(iii) Main roads were on average ten meters in width.

- (a) (i) and (ii) (b) (ii) and (iii)
(c) (i) and (iii) (d) (i), (ii) and (iii)

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

In Indus Valley Civilisation both baked and raw bricks were used. Generally the dimensional ratio of burned bricks received from all the Indus towns was 4 : 2 : 1. However ornamental bricks from Kalibangan and curved bricks from Chanhudaro have been found. Hence statement (i) is wrong. Most of the houses built in the Indus Valley Civilisation were built with one storey only, but some houses were also built with two stories as evidence of stairs have been found from some houses. Hence statement (ii) is wrong. The width of roads in Harappan cities was generally 10 meters. Hence statement (iii) is right.

29. Indus valley civilization is known for

1. For its town planning
2. For Mohenjodaro and Harappa
3. For their agricultural work
4. For its industrialization

Select the correct answer from the codes given below.

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) All of the above

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

Town planning was the unique feature of the Indus Valley Civilization. The cities and towns were well planned. Harappa and Mohenjodaro were two major cities of Indus Valley Civilization. Since the Harappa site was discovered first, that is why it is known as Harappan Civilization. Kalibangan in Rajasthan has given the first evidence of the ploughed agricultural field and evidence of business has been found from Lothal. Thus, all four statements are correct.

30. Which of the following is not correctly matched –

- | | |
|----------------|-----------------|
| (a) Alamgirpur | - Uttar Pradesh |
| (b) Lothal | - Gujarat |
| (c) Kalibangan | - Haryana |
| (d) Ropar | - Punjab |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

Kalibangan is located in Hanumangarh district of Rajasthan. It was discovered by Luigi Pio Tessitore, an Italian Indologist and was excavated by A. Ghosh in 1950-52 as a Harappan site. The excavations revealed that the western mound was a fortified enclosure with rectangular salients and towns. Except this, all are correctly matched.

31. Which of the following centres related to Indus Valley are situated in Uttar Pradesh?

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- | | |
|------------------|-------------|
| (i) Kalibangan | (ii) Lothal |
| (iii) Alamgirpur | (iv) Hulas |

Codes :

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------|
| (a) I, II, III, IV | (b) I, II |
| (c) II, III | (d) III, IV |

[U.P.P.C.S. (Pre)-2018]

Ans. (d)

Kalibangan is in Rajasthan and Lothal is situated in Gujarat. Alamgirpur is situated in Meerut, U.P. and Hulas is situated in Saharanpur, U.P. hence option (d) is the correct option.

32. Which one of the following Harappan sites is in Gujarat?

- | | |
|--|----------------|
| (a) Lothal | (b) Dabarkot |
| (c) Kalibangan | (d) Rakhigarhi |
| (e) None of the above/More than one of the above | |

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

33. For the Harappan Cultural sites and their position, which of the following is not correctly matched ?

- | | |
|----------------|-----------------|
| (a) Alamgirpur | - Uttar Pradesh |
| (b) Banawali | - Haryana |
| (c) Daimabad | - Maharashtra |
| (d) Rakhigarhi | - Rajasthan |

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

Rakhigarhi village is situated in Hisar district of Haryana along the bank of Ghaggar river. Rest of the options are correctly matched.

34. Eastern boundary of the Harappa culture is indicated by which of the following?

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) Manda | (b) Harappa |
| (c) Alamgirpur | (d) Rakhigarhi |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Eastern boundary of the Harappa culture is indicated by Alamgirpur (Meerut, Uttar Pradesh), Western Boundary is indicated by Sutkagendor (Baluchistan, Pakistan), Northern boundary by Manda (Jammu and Kashmir) and southern boundary by Daimabad (Maharashtra).

35. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below :

List – I (Harappan Site)	List – II (Location)
A. Manda	1. Rajasthan
B. Daimabad	2. Haryana
C. Kalibangan	3. Jammu-Kashmir
D. Rakhigarhi	4. Maharashtra

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	3	4	1	2
(d)	4	1	2	3

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched Harappan sites and their relative locations is as follows :

Harrapan sites -	Places
Manda	- Jammu-Kashmir
Daimabad	- Maharashtra
Kalibangan	- Rajasthan
Rakhigarhi	- Haryana

36. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists.

List-I (Harappan Site)	List-II (UT/State of India)
A. Balu	1. Uttar Pradesh
B. Manda	2. Jammu and Kashmir
C. Padri	3. Haryana
D. Hulas	4. Gujarat

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	1	4
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	2	4	3	1
(d)	3	2	4	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

The correct match of List-I with List-II is as follows :-

List-I (Harappan Site)	List-II (UT/State of India)
Balu	- Haryana
Manda	- Jammu and Kashmir
Padri	- Gujarat
Hulas	- Uttar Pradesh

37. Which of the following sites of Harappan culture are located in Sindh?

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. Harappa | 2. Mohenjodaro |
| 3. Chanhudaro | 4. Surkotada |

Indicate the correct answer from the code given below:

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------------|
| (a) 1 and 2 | (b) 2 and 3 |
| (c) 2, 3, and 4 | (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4 |

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

Among the above options, Harappa is located in Punjab (Pakistan), Mohenjodaro and Chanhudaro both are located in Sindh province in Pakistan and Surkotada is located in Gujarat.

38. Mohenjodaro is situated in which of the following?

- (a) Gujarat state of India
(b) Punjab state of India
(c) Sindh Province in Pakistan
(d) Afghanistan

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

39. The excavation at Chanhudaro was directed by –

- | | |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| (a) J. H. Mackay | (b) Sir John Marshall |
| (c) R. E. M. Wheeler | (d) Sir Aurel Stein |

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

The ruined township of Chanhudaro situated near about 130 km south of Mohenjodaro was discovered by N.G. Majumdar in 1931 and excavated on a large scale by E.J. H. Mackay in 1935-36. Mackay found bead making factory and furnace here. Some phase cut bricks were found at Chanhudaro.

40. Which site of Indus Valley is now in Pakistan?

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) Kalibangan | (b) Harappa |
| (c) Lothal | (d) Alamgirpur |

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl.) (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Harappa is an archaeological site in Montgomery district of Punjab province (now in Sahiwal district of Pakistan). It is located on the bank of the Ravi river. Kalibangan is located in Hanumangarh district of Rajasthan. Lothal is in Gujarat and Alamgirpur is located in Uttar Pradesh.

41. Rangpur, where the contemporary of Harappan civilization was found, is in –

- | | |
|----------------|---------------------------|
| (a) Punjab | (b) Eastern Uttar Pradesh |
| (c) Saurashtra | (d) Rajasthan |

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Rangpur is located in the Saurashtra region of western India on the coast of the Arabian sea in Gujarat state. On the basis of large vegetative remains, it can be said that these people used to cultivate Rice, Bajra and Sorghum.

42. Dadheri is a late Harappan site of –

- | | |
|-------------|-------------------|
| (a) Jammu | (b) Punjab |
| (c) Haryana | (d) Uttar Pradesh |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

Dadheri (Kotla Dadheri) was a prehistoric excavation site of Govindgarh, district Fatehgarh Sahib (Punjab). Dadheri is known for its painted grey ware culture which is supposed to be associated with the arrival of the Aryans.

43. Which site of Indus Valley Civilization is located in India?

- | | |
|-------------|-----------------------|
| (a) Harappa | (b) Mohenjodaro |
| (c) Lothal | (d) None of the above |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

Lothal is situated near the village of Saragwala in the Dholka Taluka in Ahmedabad district of Gujarat. It is situated on the bank of Bhogava river. It was discovered by S.R. Rao in 1954. Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro are situated in Pakistan.

44. The Harappan city represented by the archaeological site of Lothal was situated on the river –

- | | |
|-------------|-----------|
| (a) Narmada | (b) Mahi |
| (c) Bhogva | (d) Bhima |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

45. Harappan civilization, Lothal, is located in–

- | | |
|---------------|------------|
| (a) Gujarat | (b) Punjab |
| (c) Rajasthan | (d) Sindh |

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

46. The port city of Indus Valley Civilization was –

- | | |
|-------------|-----------------|
| (a) Harappa | (b) Kalibangan |
| (c) Lothal | (d) Mohenjodaro |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Lothal is the only place of Indus Valley Civilization from where the pieces of evidence of ports have been found, which is located in the east of the city.

47. Which of the following is a Harappan port?

- (a) Alexandria (b) Lothal
(c) Mahasthangarh (d) Nagapattinam

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

48. Name the major city of the Indus Valley civilization that had trade with West Asia.

- (a) Ropar (b) Lothal
(c) Kalibangan (d) None of the above

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (b)

Lothal, located in present-day Gujarat, was an important city of the Indus Valley Civilization. It is known as an ancient trading port. Situated on the shores of the Gulf of Khambhat, this site was a major harbour for trade with Western Asia.

49. What is the most significant feature of the Indus Valley Civilization?

- (a) Burnt brick buildings
(b) First true arches
(c) Buildings of worship
(d) Art and architecture
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre) 2017

Ans (e)

The use of burnt bricks in the construction of buildings was one of the main features of the Indus Valley Civilization. Burnt bricks were used in abundance in Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro. In Lothal, burnt bricks were used in the construction of drainage. Well planned architecture, advanced trade and commerce were other main features of this civilisation.

50. At which of the following Indus Valley sites was a terracotta replica relating to exploration of a plough discovered?

- (a) Dholavira (b) Kalibangan
(c) Rakhigarhi (d) Banawali

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (*)

According to the Archaeological Survey of India, Terracotta plough along with ploughed field have been found from the early phase of the Kalibangan site (Rajasthan). Apart from this, terracotta plough has also been recovered from the Indus site named Banawali located in Fatehabad district of Haryana.

51. Which among the following Harappan site terracotta of 'plough' was found?

- (a) Dholavira (b) Banawali
(c) Kalibangan (d) Lothal
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (*)

See the explanation of above question.

52. Which of the following is not an Indus Valley Civilization site?

- (a) Kalibangan (b) Ropar
(c) Patliputra (d) Lothal

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Kalibangan, Ropar and Lothal are related to Indus Valley Civilization but Pataliputra adjacent to modern-day Patna was not associated with Indus Valley civilization..

53. The largest site of Harappa in India is –

- (a) Alamgirpur (b) Kalibangan
(c) Lothal (d) Rakhigarhi

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (d)

The largest site of Indus Valley civilization in India is Rakhigarhi (Hisar district of Haryana).

54. The biggest Harappan site in India is

- (a) Rakhigarhi (b) Dholavira
(c) Kalibangan (d) Lothal

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

55. Indus Valley Civilization, which was placed on the banks of the river, they were?

1. Sindhu 2. Chenab
3. Jhelum 4. Ganga

Choose the correct answer from the code given below-
Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) All four

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

Geographically Indus Valley Civilization was spread from Jhelum-river to Hindon river, a tributary of Yamuna river in South (Alamgirpur). It consisted of rivers like Chenab, Ravi, Sutlej and Jhelum, but Ganga river did not belong to this.

56. The people of Indus Valley believed in –

- (a) Spirit and Brahma (b) Ritual
(c) Sacrificial system (d) Mother Goddess

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (*)

Undeciphered script of Indus civilization has attracted speculations and hypotheses. The people of Indus civilization probably worshipped Mother Goddess, Lord Shiva. They may have performed Yagya (fire pit found in Rajasthan and Gujarat sites). Burial rituals indicate belief in Atma or spirit, evidence of human sacrifice was also found in Mohenjodaro.

57. The Indus Valley people worshipped –

- (a) Shiva (b) Indra and Varun
(c) Brahma (d) Vishnu

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

Marshall identified the figure which he found during excavation as an early form of the Hindu God Shiva (or Rudra) or Pashupati (lord of animals) from the excavation of Harappa. The Pashupati seal in which the three faced male God is shown sitting in a yogic posture, surrounded by a Rhino and a Buffalo on the right side, an Elephant and a Tiger on the left side, makes the historian conclude that the people of those days worshipped Lord Shiva or cylindrical stones show that the people worshipped Lingam, the symbol of Lord Shiva.

58. Who was the director of the archaeological excavation that led to the discovery of Harappa and Mohenjodaro?

- (a) Lord Macaulay (b) Sir John Marshall
(c) Clive (d) Colonel Tad

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

Sir John Marshall was the Director-General of the Archaeological Survey of India from 1902 to 1928. He appointed Mr. Dayaram Sahni, who carried out excavations in the Sahiwal district of Punjab Province (Pakistan) on the left bank of Ravi river. Mr. Sahni's excavation led to the findings of ruins of Harappa in 1921. Mr. Rakhal Das Banerjee dug out the ruins of the city of Mohenjodaro (Larkana district of Sindh Province, Pakistan) in 1922.

59. Two Indians who were associated with discovery of Indus Valley Civilization, are :

- (a) Rakhal Das Banerjee and Dayaram Sahni
(b) John Marshall and Ishwari Prasad
(c) Ashirwadi Lal Srivastava and Rangnath Rao
(d) Madhosarup Vats and V.B. Rao

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

60. Which one of the following is not correctly matched ?

- (a) Harappa - Daya Ram Sahni
(b) Lothal - S.R. Rao
(c) Surkotada - J.P. Joshi
(d) Dholavira - B.K. Thapar

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (d)

Harappa was excavated by Daya Ram Sahni, Lothal by S.R. Rao and Surkotada by J.P. Joshi. But Dholavira was not excavated by B.K. Thapar. Instead, it was excavated by R.S. Bisht. Therefore, option (d) is not correctly matched.

61. The first archaeologist who excavated Harappa, but could not recognize its significance, was :

- (a) A. Cunningham (b) Sir John Marshall
(c) Mortimer Wheeler (d) George F. Dales

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

Alexander Cunningham, who headed the Archaeological Survey of India, visited this site in 1853 A.D. and 1856 A.D. Cunningham made a few small excavations at the site and reported some discoveries of ancient pottery, stone, tools and a stone seal but did not recognize its significance. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

62. Who among the following was not associated with the excavation of Harappa and Mohenjodaro?

- (a) R. D. Banerjee (b) K.N. Dikshit
(c) M.S. Vats (d) V.A. Smith

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

In 1921, Daya Ram Sahni excavated Harappa. From 1926-27 to 1933-34, M.S. Vats was associated with the excavation of Harappa. Mohenjodaro's excavation was done in 1922 by Rakhal Das Banerjee. In addition to him, some other scholars like K.N. Dixit, Ernest Mackay, Aurel Stein, A.N. Ghosh and J.P. Joshi also contributed in the discovery of this civilization. Hence, it is clear that V.A. Smith was not associated with the discovery of the Harappan Civilization rather was an Irish Indologist and historian.

63. Who among the following discovered 'Surkotada', a site of Harappan culture?

- (a) B.B. Lal (b) S.R. Rao
(c) Y.D. Sharma (d) Jagatpati Joshi
(e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Surkotada is situated in Kachchh district of Gujarat. It was discovered and excavated by Jagatpati Joshi.

64. From which one of the following places, remains of wells have been found in houses belonging to the developed stage of the Indus Valley Civilization?

- (a) Harappa (b) Kalibangan
(c) Lothal (d) Mohenjodaro

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (*)

Remains of Well and Bathroom have been found in approximately every major city of Indus Civilization.

65. What is the correct chronological order in which the following appeared in India ?

1. Gold coins
2. Punch- marked silver coins
3. Iron plough
4. Urban culture

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 3, 4, 1, 2 (b) 3, 4, 2, 1
(c) 4, 3, 1, 2 (d) 4, 3, 2, 1

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

Harappan Civilization, the most ancient civilization of India is famous for its town planning. Indus Valley Civilization was a Bronze Age Civilization. The knowledge of Iron was known much later after bronze during, the post-Vedic period around 1000 B.C. The first punch-marked coin came into existence in India during the 7th-6th century B.C. Gold coins were introduced by Indo-Greek rulers during the second century B.C.

66. The first metal used by man was :

- (a) Gold (b) Silver
(c) Copper (d) Iron

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Copper was the metal which was first used by humans, though there is variation in the period around the globe as far as the use of copper is concerned.

67. An ivory scale in Harappan context was found at –

- (a) Kalibangan (b) Lothal
(c) Dholavira (d) Banawali

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

An ivory scale in the Harappan context was found at Lothal. Lothal is a place associated with Indus Valley Civilization currently in Gujarat.

68. Which metal has so far not been discovered in Harappan sites?

- (a) Copper (b) Gold
(c) Silver (d) Iron

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

Harappan civilization is also known as the Bronze Age Civilization. From here pieces of evidence of gold, silver, copper and brass have been found, except iron. In fact, the people of Harappa were not aware of iron. In India, the beginning of the Iron Age is considered to be from the later Vedic period (app. 1000 B.C.).

69. Which one among the following sites is located in the valley of Ghaggar and its associated rivers?

- (a) Alamgirpur (b) Lothal
(c) Mohenjodaro (d) Banawali

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Banawali is an archaeological site belonging to the Indus Valley Civilization period in Fatehabad district, Haryana. Banawali is located in the valley of Ghaggar and its tributaries. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

70. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the given code :

1. Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Ropar and Kalibangan are the main sites of Indus valley civilization.
2. People of Harappa developed the road, proper housing and drainage system.
3. People of Harappa were unknown about the use of metals.

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 are correct (b) 1 and 3 are correct
(c) 2 and 3 are correct (d) 1, 2 and 3 are correct

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Ropar, Lothal and Kalibangan are the main sites of Indus Valley Civilization. In this civilization, most of the cities were designed in a grid pattern. A proper drainage system was aligned along the roads, which was covered with big stones and bricks. The forms of art were found from various sites of this civilization including seals, pottery, gold ornaments and necklaces.

71. Assertion (A) : Mohenjodaro and Harappa cities are dead now.

Reason (R) : They were discovered during excavations. In the context of the above, which one of the following is correct?

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

Mohenjodaro (now in Pakistan) is in the Larkana district of Sindh province on the right bank of the Indus river. Harappa is located in the Sahiwal district of Punjab province of Pakistan. Rakhal Das Banerjee and Dayaram Sahni were the two archaeologists who excavated the two major cities of Indus Valley Civilization. At present, these towns are extinct. Therefore, Assertion (A) and Reason (R) both are correct, but the reason is not the correct explanation. Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

72. From where was the evidence of rock-cut architecture found, with reference to Harappa civilization?

- (a) Kalibangan (b) Dholavira
(c) Kot Diji (d) Amri

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

Dholavira, which is the second largest site of Harappan Civilization in India (after Rakhigarhi) is located in Rann of Kachchh (Gujarat). R.S. Bisht and his colleagues excavated this site in 1992. Dholavira is one of the most prominent archaeological sites of Harappa Civilization which gives us important information about great bath and rock-cut reservoir which was 7 metres deep and 79 metres long.

73. Dholavira is located in the State of –

- (a) Gujarat (b) Haryana
(c) Punjab (d) Rajasthan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

74. Which Harappan city is divided into three parts?

- (a) Lothal (b) Kalibangan
(c) Dholavira (d) Surkotada

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

Dholavira is a Harappan site located in Kachchh district of Gujarat. The town was built in a rectangular shape. It was divided into three parts- Citadel, Middle town and Lower town.

75. In which of the following site remnants of three townships have been revealed?

- (a) Mohenjodaro (b) Sanghol
(c) Kalibangan (d) Dholavira
(e) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

76. Which one of the following ancient towns is well-known for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelizing water into connected reservoirs?

- (a) Dholavira (b) Kalibangan
(c) Rakhigarhi (d) Ropar

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (a)

Dholavira in Gujarat is well known for its elaborate system of water harvesting and management by building a series of dams and channelizing water into connected reservoirs.

77. A highly advanced water management system of Harappan times has been unearthed at–

- (a) Alamgirpur (b) Dholavira
(c) Kalibangan (d) Lothal

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

From Dholavira, a huge Rock-cut reservoir is found, whose size is about 79 m × 12 m and 7 meters deep, having a huge capacity to store water. People of Dholavira were familiar with the advanced water management system. From the earliest evidence, people used to store water in this reservoir by building dams.

78. Which of the following sites has yielded evidence of a double burial?

- (a) Kuntasi (b) Dholavira
(c) Lothal (d) Kalibangan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (*)

The evidence of three double burials has been found from Lothal. It was an important port of the Harappan culture. The evidence of double burials also has been found from Kalibangan and Rakhigarhi.

79. Recently, from excavations of Harappan site Sonauli what was found ?

- (a) Human burials (b) Animal burials
(c) Residential building (d) Protecting wall

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

Sinauli is an archaeological site located in Baraut Tehsil, Baghpat district, Uttar Pradesh, where 125 graves belonging to Indus Valley Civilization were found. These graves are oriented in a North-South direction and most are identified as primary human burials. Some of the burials are found with animal bones and gold, copper and bangles.

80. In which State of India is the Harappan Civilization site Mandi situated?

- (a) Gujarat (b) Haryana
(c) Rajasthan (d) Uttar Pradesh

[U.P.P.C.S. (Pre)-2021]

Ans. (d)

Mandi is a village in the Muzaffarnagar district of Uttar Pradesh. It became famous after discovery and loot of an ancient treasure trove by villagers in June 2000. As per ASI, the jewellery found belonged to the late Harappan period.

81. For clothing, cotton cultivation was first introduced in–

- (a) Egypt (b) Mesopotamia
(c) Central America (d) India

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

Cotton was first cultivated in India for clothing. In 1922, Rakhhal Das Banerjee took an interest in the site of Mohenjo-Daro for excavation. Evidence of the earliest cotton cultivation was found by excavation in India. From India, it reached Greece where it was called "Sindon". The cotton cultivation in India started in 3000 B.C. while it was cultivated in Egypt in 2500 B.C.

82. Which of the following characterizes/characterize the people of Indus Civilization?

1. They possessed great places and temples.
2. They worshipped, both male and female deities.
3. They employed horse-drawn chariots in warfare.

Select the correct answer using the code given below

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) Only 2
(c) All of these (d) None of these

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

No temple or place of worship has been found in excavation from Indus Valley Civilization till date. The only religious source from this civilization is statues made of mud and stone and seals which were found here. By this, it is known that female deities, Shiva or Pashupati and animals like snake, elephant were worshipped. Worship of plants and trees, or inanimate stone or other objects in the form of 'Linga' or 'yoni' symbols was famous during that period.

83. Regarding the Indus Valley Civilization, consider the following statements

1. It was predominantly a secular civilization and the religious element, though present, did not dominate the scene.
2. During this period, cotton was used for manufacturing textiles in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2011

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

Indus Valley Civilization is considered to be a secular civilization with no trace of theocratic or organized religion. Cotton textiles were produced during the Harappan period as shown by artefact evidence.

84. One of the following sites from where the famous bull-seal of Indus Valley Civilization was found-

- (a) Harappa (b) Chanhudaro
(c) Lothal (d) Mohenjodaro

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Mohenjodaro is an archaeological site in the province of Sindh, Pakistan (excavated by R.D. Banerjee in 1922). From this site, various sculptures, seals, pottery, gold and jewellery have been found. But the most famous among them is the humped bull seal.

85. The shape of which tree is found in the seals from the Indus Civilization?

- (a) Mango (b) Pipal
(c) Parijat (d) Sal

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Most of the seals discovered from Indus Valley Civilisation were made of steatite. A few of them were also made of terracotta, agate, chert etc. Most of seals were square in shape but few were in cube, circle and cylindrical shapes too. Pipal tree is represented number of times on Indus seals depicting that Pipal had important/sacred value to Indus people.

86. Which one of the following animals is not depicted on the Harappan seal ?

- (a) Bull (b) Elephant
(c) Horse (d) Sheep

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2009

Ans. (c)

People of the Harappa civilization were known to horses, but no pieces of evidence have been found on seals. A great majority of seals found in Indus Valley civilization carry short inscriptions with figures of the one-horned animal (most common), the Buffalo, the Tiger, the Rhinoceros, the Goat and the Elephant.

87. Remains of which animal have not been discovered in the Indus Valley Civilization?

- (a) Lion (b) Horse
(c) Cow (d) Elephant

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Among given options, the evidence of cow and elephant have been found and there is some dispute regarding horse, but the latest excavation has revealed the evidence of horse. The evidence of lion from the excavation of Harappan Civilization has not been mentioned anywhere. Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

88. Which of the following animals was not known to the people of the Indus Valley Civilization?

- (a) Bull (b) Horse
(c) Elephant (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Among the given options evidence of Bull and Elephant have been found. Seal of Zebu Bull has been found. Seals depicting Elephant have also been found. There is some dispute regarding horse but latest excavation has revealed evidence of horse. However, Horses did not play any major role during the Indus Valley Civilisation. BPSC has accepted (b) as correct answer.